



Golden Goose of Referrals Worksheet

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Name: _____ Date: _____

While interviewing your connection, keep these recommendations & questions in mind and fill out this worksheet after. The questions you need to answer will be highlighted yellow, recommended scripts are in green.

Opening Remarks: introduce yourself, thank them for getting on the call and taking time out of their schedule to help.

Then, grill them on the interview process. Applications, online assessments (questions, topics, etc.), interviews, offer, and then ask for any advice or strategy tips they have for someone who's interviewing there.

- Learn about company/values - resources - ask about their journey.
- Why did they pick that company? How do they like it so far? What's their history, background, and plans for the future?

What is it like to work at their company / what is the culture?

How did they land that specific role? What was the interview like?

When do these positions open up?

When were they hired?



GET REFERRAL:

You could say something like: *"This is all so helpful, and I really really appreciate the advice you're giving me — I know in this process that companies often get thousands of applicants to these roles, and it's very difficult to stand out from the crowd, so I was wondering if you'd be able to refer me when the position opens up. It would really really help out a lot!"*

Overcome Objections: When they use these phrases:

1. **"The referral doesn't do much at my company."**
 - a. *"Totally understand — I expect that at big companies like yours a lot of people get referrals, so it might not make a huge difference. But it can't hurt, right? I get that in the end it might not change much, but in the off chance that it does, would you be able to submit one for me? It would really really help out!"*
2. **"I don't know what our referral process is / I haven't heard much about that, I'll have to look into it."**
 - a. *"Totally understand, makes complete sense, and I appreciate that. When do you think you'll be able to find out about the referral process? Is there someone you'll have to ask?"*

Get Alternative Form of Contact

"Thank you, that would be amazing! Now, do you check LinkedIn super often? Or is there another way I can contact you that would work better, like email or phone number? I just want to make sure I can get in contact when the role opens up."

Get Recruiter / Hiring Manager

Very important next step, and is what will drastically improve your chances if you can pull it off. Having a recruiting contact at the company is incredibly valuable. This is that hiring manager or recruiter email you want to go for.

"Thanks for that! Now, would it also be possible to connect me with a recruiter or hiring manager at the company who hires interns [or full-time role]? Again, mainly because I know that you guys probably get thousands of applications and I just want to make sure my resume at least gets looked at by someone."

- Can even ask for their recruiter, **person who hired them** (if they're in your desired role).
- **GET EMAILS, not just LinkedIn.**

What other connections did you acquire?(intern coordinator, hiring manager, recruiter, software engineers, etc.)

- **"I'm not sure if I can give out their email address, here's their LinkedIn."**

"Got it, in my experience, recruiters usually like it because their job is to get a pipeline of qualified candidates — so it actually helps them out a lot if someone emails them directly. But what if you send them a quick email with my resume & contact info & the role, and that way it's someone internal who reaches out? Would that work? Again, I really appreciate it!"

In order of value, but go for 2/3!

Who did you get?

- ☐ Hiring Manager: best case, person who's hiring for THAT role itself.
- ☐ Recruiter: someone who goes out and sources talent. Still great.
- ☐ Additional Software Engineer

What to do with these additional contacts?

You want to send them emails over and over again — mere exposure effect.

- ☐ If you have a recruiter email, did you email them back?
 - "Hi _____, my name is _____, and I'm a computer science student at [University]! I just applied for the [internship @ company] and wanted to connect with you to follow up on my application and express enthusiasm for the role! Thank you."
- ☐ If you can't find the recruiter, did you find one on LinkedIn and send it to them?
 - Or ask them to connect you with any recruiter.
- ☐ Then, follow up every 1-2 weeks until you get the interview or get rejected.



Sometimes, they won't even give you the call, and will instead ask to send your questions via chat — if they don't have time for the call.

- Here's a script for that:

- *"Totally understand where you're coming from! My main questions are:"*

- *"What was your interview / application process for the [position]? I would love to learn how [company name] recruits and interview for that role."*
- *"When the application opens up, would it be possible to submit a referral for me? I know how companies like [company name] tend to get thousands of applications for [role], and I just want to make sure I have a fighting chance of at least getting my resume seen. I'd really appreciate it!"*

If Interns Are Finished...

- If you're going for internships, sometimes you'll be connecting with interns at that company.
- Often, those interns will be finished (if it's not the summer) — in that case, ask them to **introduce you to their manager via email**.
 - Or another software engineer.

Chat Referrals

Now, the only exception is sometimes for big companies people will give out referrals via chat — it happens a decent amount, and if they offer it, then take it.

- ☐ Did you get a chat offer?
- ☐ Did you take it?

If you really want to blind message, then do it for big companies and never for small ones.

For smaller companies, since you have less people to work with, you'll need to put more work into each step.